

Gateway

A combination of a software program and a piece of hardware that passes data between networks. You typically encounter a gateway when you log on to an Internet site or when you send e-mail to someone who uses a e-mail system different from the one that you do. In wireless networking, gateways can also serve as security and authentication devices, access points, and more.

HomePlug

A home-networking standard where devices connect using cables plugged into regular AC outlets, removing the need for running physical cables or configuring a wireless network. The maximum throughput is 14 Mbps.

Hot spot

In wireless networking, a hot spot is a specific part of an access point's range in which the general public can walk up and use the network. The service may be available either free or for a fee, and the hot spot's range is usually short to control the physical proximity of the user. In some parts of the world, it is called a cool spot.

Hub

A piece of networking hardware that serves as a central connection point for multiple PCs or other devices, usually on a wired or wireless Ethernet network. A passive hub simply transmits data from any of its connected devices to the rest of the network. An active, or manageable, hub can also monitor network traffic and configure its ports.

IEEE

Institute of Electrical and Electronics Engineers. Pronounced 'eye-triple-E', this non-profit US engineering organisation develops, promotes, and reviews standards within the electronics and computer science industries.